

Measured Misconduct

Scene Adaptation from Shakespeare's Measure for Measure, Act 2, Scene 4

Characters on stage: Angelo and Isabella

Projected Text Source: President Donald Trump, Harvey Weinstein, Danny Masterson
[Scene Introduction]

Setting: an enclosed white cube.

Projection Note: Throughout the scene, real-world statements made by President Trump, Harvey Weinstein and Danny Masterson are projected on the white walls. These statements are timed to sync with Shakespeare's lines and to interrogate themes of power, coercion, and misogyny.

Content Warning: This scene includes references to sexual violence and abusive language.

[Video: Black screen. White text fades in: "Measured Misconduct: Larry, Harvey, Angelo et al." Text fades to black.]

[Video: Black Screen. White text fades in "Shakespeare's Measure for Measure (Act 2, Scene 4)". Text fades to blank.]

[Video: Angelo is in the center of the room, reflecting on power and appearance. Isabella is seen in the corner hands folded in front of her, head down.]

[Projection: On the wall behind Angelo and positioned beside Isabella, white text appears, displaying a quote from Louis C.K.:]

"I also took advantage of the fact that I was widely admired in my and their community, which disabled them from sharing their story and brought hardship to them when they tried because people who look up to me didn't want to hear it. I didn't think that I was doing any of that because my position allowed me not to think about it."

Angelo (spoken):

The state whereon I studied
Is, like a good thing being often read,
Grown "sere" and tedious. Yea, my gravity,

[Video: An overlay appears—a close-up of Angelo's face fills the frame.]

Angelo (spoken):

Wherein—let no man hear me—I take pride,
Could I with boot change for an idle plume
Which the air beats for vain. O place, O form,

[Video: The close-up overlay fades away, revealing Angelo once again in the center of the room.]

Angelo (spoken):

How often dost thou with thy case, thy habit,
Wrench awe from fools, and tie the wiser souls
To thy false seeming! Blood, thou art blood.
Let's write "good angel" on the devil's horn.
'Tis not the devil's crest.

[Sound: Loud knocking.]

[Video: Angelo is startled.]

Angelo (spoken):

How now, who's there?

[Projection: On the wall behind Angelo and positioned beside Isabella, white text appears, displaying a quote from Louis C.K.:]

"I'm not condoning rape, obviously. You should never rape anyone. Unless you have a reason, like if you want to fuck somebody and they won't let you. In which case-what other option do you have? How else are you supposed to have an orgasm in their body if you don't rape them, like what the fuck."

[Video: Angelo shifts uncomfortably, brushing his hand across his groin as confusion and arousal flicker across his face.]

Angelo (spoken):

Why does my blood thus muster to my heart,
Making both it unable for itself
And dispossessing all my other parts
Of necessary fitness?

[Video: Isabella walks across the room toward Angelo.]

Angelo (spoken):

How now, fair maid?

[Projection: White text appears on the wall behind Angelo and Isabella. Displaying the following quote from President Donald Trump:]

"You know, I'm automatically attracted to beautiful — "

Isabella (spoken):

I come to know your pleasure.

[Projection: On the wall behind Angelo and Isabella, white text appears. It displays the following quote from President Donald Trump:]

"I have seen women manipulate men with just a twitch of their eye — or perhaps another body part."

[Video: Isabella approaches and comes to a stop, standing face-to-face with Angelo.]

Angelo (spoken):

That you might know it would much better please me
Than to demand what 'tis. Your brother cannot live.

[Projection: On the wall behind Angelo and Isabella, white text appears, positioned right above their heads. It displays the following quote from Louis C.K.:]

"The power I had over these women is that they admired me. And I wielded that power irresponsibly."

[Video: As Angelo turns to walk away, Isabella reaches out and grabs his hand, pulling him back toward her.]

Isabella (spoken):

Even so. Heaven keep your Honor.

[Projection: On the wall behind Angelo and Isabella, white text appears. It displays the following quote from President Donald Trump:]

"I am your warrior. I am your justice."

[Video: Angelo pulls his hand from Isabella's grasp and holds it up toward her in a stopping gesture.]

Angelo (spoken):

Yet may he live a while. And it may be
As long as you or I. Yet he must die.

[Video: Isabella bows her head toward Angelo, her posture subdued and deliberate.]

[Projection: On the wall behind Angelo and Isabella, white text appears. It displays the following quote from President Donald Trump:]

"I am your retribution."

Isabella (spoken):

Under your sentence?

Angelo (spoken):

Yea.

[Projection: On the wall behind Angelo and Isabella, white text appears. It displays the following quote from President Donald Trump:]

"It is a disgrace and people should pay dearly for such false accusations."

[Video: Isabella remains with her head bowed, her posture still subdued and deliberate.]

Isabella (spoken):

When, I beseech you? That in his reprieve,

Longer or shorter, he may be so fitted

That his soul sicken not.

[Projection: On the wall behind Angelo and Isabella, white text appears. It displays the following quote from Louis C.K.:]

"I'm not condoning rape, obviously. You should never rape anyone. Unless you have a reason, like if you want to fuck somebody and they won't let you. In which case-what other option do you have? How else are you supposed to have an orgasm in their body if you don't rape them, like what the fuck."

[Video: Isabella remains motionless, head bowed, her quiet, deliberate posture holding the tension in the room. Angelo speaks down at her, gesturing with his hand like a judge's gavel. He then places his hand under her chin and lifts her head to meet his gaze.]

Angelo (spoken):

Say you so? Then I shall pose you quickly:

Which had you rather, that the most just law

Now took your brother's life, 'or, ' to redeem him Give up your body to such sweet uncleanness

As she that he hath stained?

[Video: Cut to a close-up of Angelo and Isabella. With Angelo's hand still beneath her chin, Isabella lifts her gaze and looks directly into his eyes.]

Isabella (spoken):

Sir, believe this:

I had rather give my body than my soul.

[Projection: On the wall behind Angelo and Isabella, white text appears. It displays the following quote from President Donald Trump:]

"I have seen women manipulate men with just a twitch of their eye — or perhaps another body part."

Angelo (spoken):

I talk not of your soul.

[Projection: On the wall behind Angelo and Isabella, white text appears. It displays the following quote from Harvey Weinstein:]

"I didn't do anything wrong. I mean, I might have done some things that are immoral. But I didn't do anything that was illegal."

[Video: Isabella places a hand on Angelo's shoulder and slowly walks around him, her movements calm but predatory.]

Angelo continues (spoken):

Answer to this:

I, now the voice of the recorded law,

Pronounce a sentence on your brother's life.

Might there not be a charity in sin

To save this brother's life?

[Projection: On the wall behind Angelo and Isabella, white text appears. It displays the following quote from President Donald Trump:]

"I am your warrior. I am your justice."

[Video: Isabella kneels before Angelo. Cut to a close-up of Angelo's face, with the back of Isabella's head visible at the bottom of the frame.]

[Projection: On the wall behind Angelo and Isabella, barely visible, white text appears. It displays the following quote from President Donald Trump:]

"I have seen women manipulate men with just a twitch of their eye — or perhaps

another body part."

Isabella (spoken):

That I do beg his life, if it be sin
Heaven let me bear it. You granting of my suit,
If that be sin, I'll make it my morn prayer
To have it added to the faults of mine
And nothing of your answer.

[Video: Close-up of Angelo. The back of Isabella's head is still visible at the bottom of the frame.]

Angelo (spoken):

Nay, but hear me.
Your sense pursues not mine. Either you are
ignorant,
Or seem so, crafty, and that's not good.

[Video: Cut to a wide shot of the room. Isabella remains kneeling before Angelo.]

[Projection: On the wall behind Angelo and Isabella, white text appears. It displays the following quote from President Donald Trump:]

"Women have one of the great acts of all time. The smart ones act very feminine and needy."

Isabella (spoken):

Let 'me' be ignorant and in nothing good,
But graciously to know I am no better.

[Video: Angelo forcefully kicks Isabella, knocking her to the ground.]

[Projection: On the wall behind Angelo and Isabella, white text appears. It displays the following quote from Louis C.K.:]

"I didn't think that I was doing any of that because my position allowed me not to think about it."

Angelo (spoken):

Admit no other way to save his life—
As I subscribe not that, nor any other—
But, in the loss of question, that you, his sister,

[Video: Isabella lies on her side on the ground as Angelo looms over her,

speaking down with a volatile mix of excitement and anger. Maintaining eye contact, Isabella slowly runs a hand through her hair and gazes up at him.]

Angelo (spoken):

Finding yourself desired of such a person
Whose credit with the judge, or own great place,
Could fetch your brother from the manacles
Of the all-^r bindingⁿ law, and that there were

[Projection: On the wall behind Angelo and Isabella, white text appears. It displays the following quote from President Donald Trump:]

"You know, they're standing there with no clothes. 'Is everybody okay?' And you see these incredible looking women, and so, I sort of get away with things like that."

[Video: Isabella holds her gaze on Angelo, slowly running her hand up her thigh as she looks up at him. Angelo kneels beside her, running his hand just above her body—hovering without making contact.]

Angelo (spoken):

No earthly mean to save him but that either
You must lay down the treasures of your body
To this supposed, or else to let him suffer,
What would you do?

[Video: Cut to a close-up of Isabella lying on the floor. She slowly sits up, subtly parts her legs, and deliberately maneuvers herself closer to Angelo—ending with his knee positioned between her thighs.]

Isabella (spoken):

As much for my poor brother as myself.
That is, were I under the terms of death,
Th' impression of keen whips I'd wear as rubies
And strip myself to death as to a bed
That longing have been sick for, ere I'd yield
My body up to shame.

[Video: Angelo places a hand over his heart, then abruptly dismisses Isabella with a sharp wave of his hand.]

Angelo (spoken):

Then must your brother die.

[Video: They lock eyes, holding each other's gaze in a moment of charged stillness.]

Isabella (spoken):

Women—help, heaven—men their creation mar
In profiting by them. Nay, call us ten times frail,

[Video: Cut to a wide shot of the room. Isabella remains on the floor, propped up on her arms behind her. Angelo stands over her, his legs planted on either side of her body, looming.]

[Projection: On the wall behind Angelo and Isabella, white text appears. It displays the following quote from President Donald Trump:]

"And for those who have been wronged and betrayed, I am your retribution. I am your retribution."

Isabella (spoken):

For we are soft as our complexions are,
And credulous to false prints.

[Projection: On the wall behind Angelo and Isabella, white text appears. It displays the following quote from President Donald Trump:]

"Women have one of the great acts of all time. The smart ones act very feminine and needy, but inside they are real killers."

Angelo (spoken):

I think it well.
And from this testimony of your own sex,
Since I suppose we are made to be no stronger
Than faults may shake our frames, let me be bold.

[Projection: On the wall behind Angelo and Isabella, white text appears. It displays the following quote from Judge Derek Johnson:]

"If someone doesn't want to have sexual intercourse, the body shuts down. The body will not permit that to happen unless a lot of damage is inflicted, and we heard nothing about that in this case. That tells me that the victim in this case, although she wasn't necessarily willing, she didn't put up a fight."

[Video: Angelo bends down and forcefully grabs Isabella by the throat.]

Angelo (spoken):

I do arrest your words. Be that you are—

That is, a woman. If you be more, you're none.
If you be one, as you are well expressed
By all external warrants, show it now
By putting on the destined livery.

[Video: Cut to a close-up of Isabella. Angelo's hand remains tight around her throat. Isabella reaches up, pries his hand away, and removes it.]

Isabella (spoken):

I have no tongue but one.

[Video: Cut to a wide shot of the room. Isabella remains on the floor, propped up on her arms behind her. Angelo stands over her, looming.]

Isabella (spoken):

Gentle my lord,
Let me entreat you speak the former language.

Angelo (spoken):

Plainly conceive I love you.

[Projection: On the wall behind Angelo and Isabella, white text appears. It displays the following quote from Larry Nassar:]

"Hell hath no fury like a woman scorned."

Isabella (spoken):

My brother did love Juliet,
And you tell me that he shall die for 't.

[Projection: On the wall behind Angelo and Isabella, white text appears. It displays the following quote from Danny Masterson:]

"This is beyond ridiculous."

[Video: Angelo kneels beside Isabella, his posture lowered in a pleading gesture.]

Angelo (spoken)

He shall not, Isabel, if you give me love.

[Projection: On the wall behind Angelo and Isabella, white text appears. It displays the following quote from President Donald Trump:]

"I'm not allowed to defend myself, and yet other people are allowed to say whatever they want about me."

Isabella (spoken):

I know your virtue hath a license in 't
Which seems a little fouler than it is
To pluck on others.

[Projection: On the wall behind Angelo and Isabella, white text appears. It displays the following quote from Judge Raymon Dean:]

"As the gentlemen on the jury will understand, when a woman says no, she doesn't always mean it. Men can't turn their emotions on and off like a tap like some women can."

Angelo (spoken):

Believe me, on mine honor,
My words express my purpose.

[Video: Angelo pulls Isabella to her feet. Cut to a close-up of Isabella as she looks directly at him, slowly inching closer.]

Isabella (spoken):

Ha! Little honor to be much believed,
And most pernicious purpose. Seeming, seeming!

[Video: Cut to a wide shot of the room. Isabella stands directly in front of Angelo, their faces inches apart. Angelo steps forward, pushing her backward with his advancing body.]

[Projection: On the wall behind Angelo and Isabella, white text appears. It displays the following quote from President Donald Trump:]

"You've got to deny, deny, deny and push back on these women. If you admit to anything and any culpability, then you're dead. You've got to be strong. You've got to be aggressive. You've got to push back hard. You've got to deny anything that's said about you."

Isabella (spoken):

I will proclaim thee, Angelo, look for 't.
Sign me a present pardon for my brother

[Video: Cut to a close-up of Angelo and Isabella. Angelo smirks as he pushes her back against the wall.]

[Sound: A clipboard slams against the wall.]

Isabella (spoken):

Or with an outstretched throat I'll tell the world

Aloud What man thou art.

[Video: Angelo pins Isabella against the wall, holding her in place with both hands pressed above her.]

Angelo (spoken):

Who will believe thee, Isabel?

My unsoiled name,

[Video: Cut to a wide shot of the room. Angelo forcefully grabs Isabella and pulls her toward him.]

Angelo (spoken):

th' austereness of my life,

[Projection: On the wall to the left of Angelo and Isabella, white text appears. It displays the following quote from Danny Masterson:]

"I have never been charged with a crime, let alone convicted of one."

[Video: Angelo pulls Isabella toward the center of the room.]

[Projection: On the wall to the left of Angelo and Isabella, white text appears. It displays the following quote from Danny Masterson:]

"The public will finally be able to learn the truth and see how I've been railroaded by this woman."

Angelo (spoken):

My vouch against you, and my place i' th' state

Will so your accusation overweigh

[Video: Isabella stands in front of Angelo with her arms outstretched to her sides. An overlay of her appears on the left side of the screen, showing her covering her mouth first with her left hand, then with her right.]

Angelo (spoken):

That you shall stifle in your own report

And smell of calumny.

[Projection: On the wall to the left of Angelo and Isabella, white text appears. It displays the following quote from Danny Masterson:]

"I will beat her in court— and look forward to it."

[Video: Angelo steps closer, positioning himself behind Isabella.]

Angelo (spoken):

I have begun,
And now I give my sensual race the rein.

[Video: Angelo grabs Isabella's arms one by one, placing them behind her back. He forcefully bends her over as he presses himself against her.]

Angelo (spoken):

Fit thy consent to my sharp appetite;
Lay by all nicety and prolixious blushes
That banish what they sue for. Redeem thy brother
By yielding up thy body to my will,
Or else he must not only die the death,

[Video: Angelo grabs Isabella by the hair, yanks her up, pulls her back toward him, and then throws her against the wall.]

[Projection: On the wall to the left of Angelo and Isabella, white text appears. It displays the following quote from Larry Nassar:]

"The stories that are being fabricated."

[Sound: Isabella slams against the wall.]

Angelo (spoken):

But thy unkindness shall his death draw out
To ling'ring sufferance.
Answer me tomorrow,

[Video: Isabella slowly turns around and slides down the wall. She gradually pushes herself backward on the ground, looking up at Angelo as if trying to distance herself from him.]

Angelo (spoken):

Or by the affection that now guides me most,
I'll prove a tyrant to him.

[Projection: On the wall to the left of Angelo and Isabella, white text appears. It displays the following quote from President Donald Trump:]

"Also the things he got in trouble for were things that had nothing to do with me. He got in trouble and went to jail. This had nothing to do with me."

[Video: Isabella pushes herself backward along the ground until she's trapped in the corner, looking up at Angelo. Her hands cover her mouth as though she has been silenced.]

Angelo (spoken):

As for you,
Say what you can, my false o'erweighs your true.

[Projection: On the wall to the left of Angelo and Isabella, white text appears. It displays the following quote from William Strampel:]

"I hold your entire future in my hand and I can do whatever I want with it."

[Video: Angelo walks out of frame, leaving Isabella trapped in the corner. Fade out.]